Daksh Vasudeva
Adobe NEXT Campus Leaders challenge

Adobe × CHITKARA UNIVERSITY

Release the Firefly

Make something. Find your people.

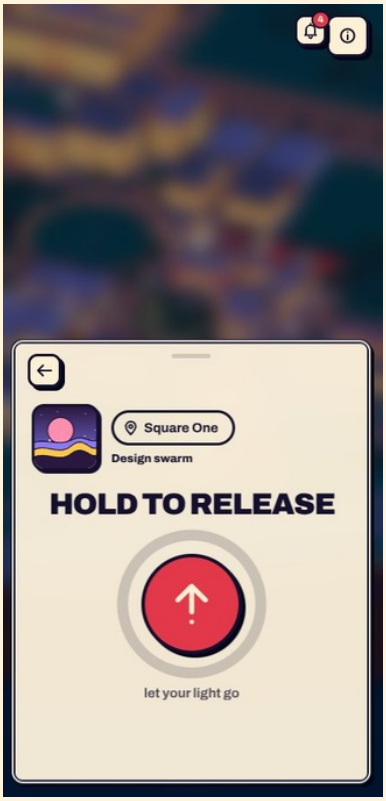
For two weeks, I want students at Chitkara to try Adobe Firefly, put what they make on our campus map and meet people they might not otherwise talk to.

I started with a gallery on a map, but sharing images alone didn't feel like enough. I wanted students to have someone to talk to, learn from and make things with. Workshops, open brainstorming sessions and the map would bring those parts together.

Click to try the app



Make something. Meet someone.







Make something.

Make an image in Firefly and add it with the prompt you used. Pick a campus building and your school's swarm, or colour group. Hold Release, and your image becomes a firefly above that spot.

Give it a Glow.

Open a firefly to see who made it and how. If you like the work, give it a Glow. There are no dislikes, and nobody has to give a Glow back. It encourages people to keep making.

Meet someone new.

Each night at 9 PM, the campaign will offer groups of 3-5 students from different schools a public spot and time to meet. You can choose whether to join. Make one piece together, and it becomes a star on the map.

The board will rank Glows received, with one Glow per person per piece. It will show first names and totals. You can hide from the board, and who gave a Glow will stay private.

You can already try the demo without signing in. Your uploads and Glows stay in your browser. The people, totals, meetings and rewards shown are examples.

How I built it.

I wanted people from Chitkara to recognise the places they walk past every day. I used my campus photos and maps to build a 3D model with AI assistance. I kept checking the model and asking for changes to the roads, entrances, buildings and lighting.



Picasso



Square One



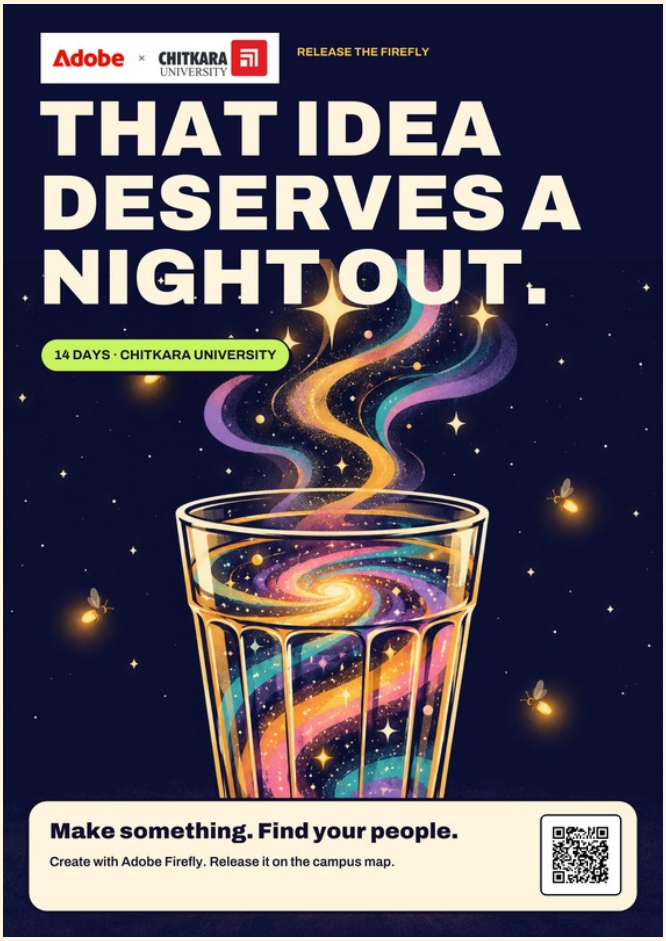


I developed the icons and screen designs with AI assistance, then added them to the map. I chose cream cards, dark outlines, bold type and warm colours for the app and campaign.

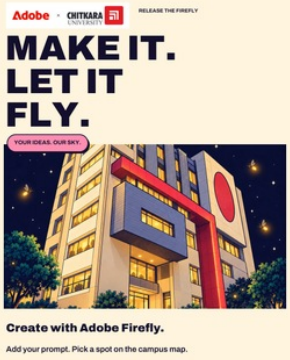
The final page shows the photographs, model, interface and motion studies together on my process board.

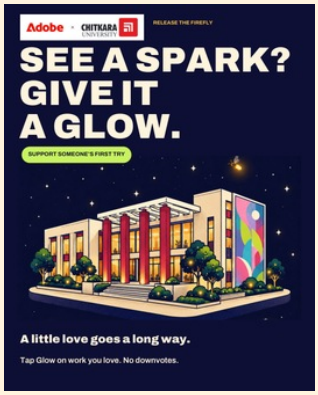
The campaign on campus.

I made three posters and four feed cards for places students already spend time, on campus and online. The four illustrations show a chai galaxy, Turing, Picasso and Square One. I used AI-generated concept art to work out the look of the campaign.







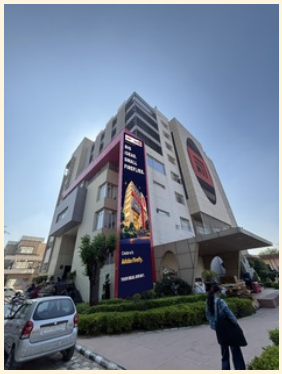




Open all posters and social artwork

These mockups show where the hoardings could go at Square One and Picasso. I would agree on their size and mounting with campus staff before putting them up.





Watch the campaign.

The longer film shows how the whole idea works. The 15-second cut is a quick invitation to try it. Both use the campus model, app screens and the same voiceover.



Click a button below to open the film, then press play.

Click to watch the full campaign film

Click to watch the 15-second film

I developed the script, visuals and timing with AI assistance. I built the animation around the campus model and app screens, then matched it to the AI-generated voiceover.

These films show the campaign concept. The Firefly-generated hero and video and the Firefly Board link are still to be added.

How I'll run it.

I'll run hands-on Firefly workshops and open talks. Students can sit with me and bring an idea or unfinished work. We'll brainstorm, try better prompts and look at composition, colour and typography. I'll use what I've learnt in communication design to help them improve their work, with time for questions and feedback.

Days 1-3	I'll put QR posters at Square One, the library, school entrances and hostel noticeboards. The first workshops will introduce Firefly and help students make their first image.
Days 4-7	I'll share student work with permission and explain Glow. At 9 PM, hosts will help groups meet at public campus spots and make one small piece together.
Days 8-13	I'll keep the talks and feedback sessions open, share group work and print corridor posters. I'll invite students from schools with fewer participants and collect permission for the projection and zine.
Day 14	I'll hold Swarm Night and project the top ten by Glows received alongside group work. New releases and Glows will close, while the final board and an archive of work shared with permission will stay online.

Students can earn rewards.

Spark, Glow, Lantern and Beacon will show progress. I'm proposing story cards, corridor posters, glow pins, a projection, a zine, certificates and portfolio reviews. Any Adobe perks will stay tentative.

Students will keep credit for their work.

Students will use their own images, or images they have permission to use. Each artwork will show its prompt so others can learn how it was made. I'll get permission before publishing names or work, and keep meetings optional and public. I'll count how many students make their first image, which schools take part, how many return and how many group pieces they make.

How the campus map developed.

I tested the look with the clay view and style references before building the day and night map.

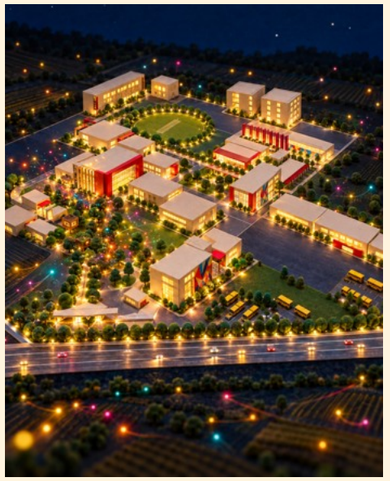
The paper and illustrated studies were generated with AI.



Clay blockout



Style reference



Paper-model study



Illustrated revision



Day version



First night version

Original prompt excerpt

Treat the chosen panel as a strict composition blueprint: preserve its exact camera angle, projection, framing, building footprints and positions, relative heights, road, parking, cricket oval and tree avenue. Only change materials, lighting and facade details.

Read the full original prompts

Final interactive map



Download the revised poster layouts

Release the Firefly

Daksh / Chitkara

I started with a campus gallery.


The campus map


Picasso


Square One

I wanted students to recognise their own campus.

I wanted students to meet through the things they make.

Students make something, give Glows and meet.

I checked the roads against the map and corrected their spacing.

I used AI to build an interactive 3D campus.

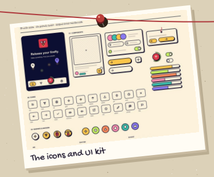

The creeper walkway

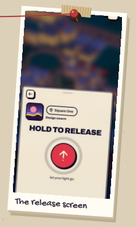
I used my photos to guide the AI.


Newton


Edison


The interactive campus model


The icons and UI kit


The release screen

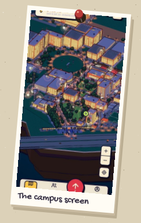


The Meet screen

I kept the red building details and made the windows glow.


Fleming

I adjusted the entrances and road spacing.


The campus screen

I made four AI art studies.


Chai galaxy


Turing

These four images are AI concept art.



The release animation



The Glow animation

I replaced extra instructions with simple taps.

The board counts Glows received. The giver stays private.


Picasso


Square One



The 9 PM match

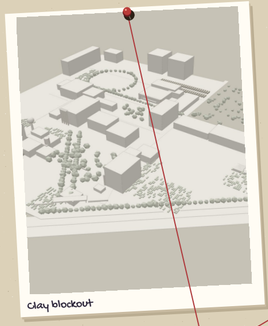
I recorded the voiceover first, then timed the animation to it.

I used AI for the voiceover.

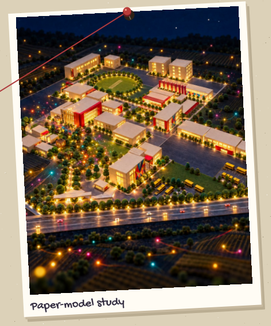
The demo opens without signing in. Try it on your phone.

Open the app

Map studies


Clay blockout


Style reference

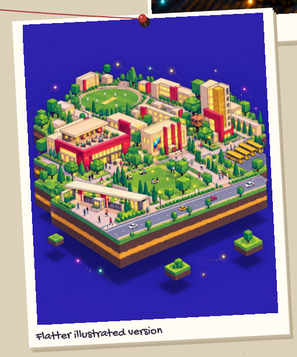

Paper-model study

Original prompt

Treat the chosen panel as a strict composition blueprint: preserve its exact camera angle, projection, framing, building footprints and positions, relative heights, road, parking, cricket oval and tree avenue. Only change materials, lighting and facade details.




Illustrated concept


Flatter illustrated version

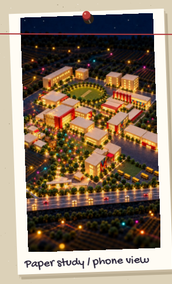
Original revision prompt

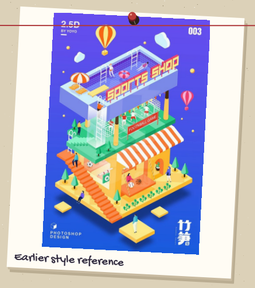
This must look like a drawn 2.5D editorial illustration, with large clear shapes and restrained detail, not a rendered 3D scene.

Day and night versions


Day version


First night version


Paper study / phone view



Earlier style reference

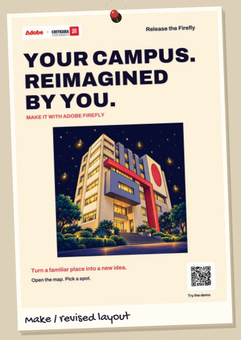
Poster layouts



Earlier layout



Launch / revised layout



Make / revised layout



Meet / revised layout

FINAL POSTER LAYOUTS

I kept the copy and revised the poster layouts.

FINAL INTERACTIVE MAP


Final interactive campus